title: "Medicines Management Policy" version: "1.0" effectiveDate: "[Insert Date]" reviewDate: "[Insert Date – usually annually]" appliesTo: "All staff involved in the handling, administration, storage, and disposal of medicines at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]"

Medicines Management Policy

Policy Title: Medicines Management
Effective Date: [Insert Date]
Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]
Version: 1.0
Applies to: All staff involved in the handling, administration, storage, and disposal of medicines at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to the safe, effective, and accountable management of medicines to promote the health and wellbeing of our residents.

This policy ensures compliance with:

- The Medicines Act 1968
- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- Care Quality Commission (CQC) Fundamental Standards
- NHS and local prescribing and medicines management guidance

2. Purpose

This policy aims to:

- Ensure medicines are handled safely and correctly
- Protect residents' rights to receive the correct medicines at the right time
- Minimise risks associated with medicines errors
- Comply with legal and professional standards

3. Scope

This policy applies to all staff who:

- Administer medicines
- Store and order medicines
- Record and report on medicines usage
- Dispose of medicines

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager:

- Ensures medicines management policy is implemented and monitored
- Ensures staff are competent and trained in medicines management
- Reports medicines-related incidents to CQC and relevant authorities

Responsible Staff (e.g., Nurses, Care Staff):

- Administer medicines only after appropriate training and competency checks
- Maintain accurate records of medicines administration
- Report and document any errors or adverse reactions

5. Medicines Handling Procedures

5.1 Ordering and Receiving Medicines

- Medicines must be ordered only on valid prescriptions by authorised prescribers
- Check medicines received against the prescription and delivery note
- Report any discrepancies or damaged medicines immediately

5.2 Storage

- Store medicines securely in a locked cupboard or trolley with restricted access
- Maintain appropriate storage conditions (temperature monitoring for fridge items)
- Separate controlled drugs and maintain controlled drug registers

5.3 Administration

- Follow the “Five Rights” of medication administration:
    - Right resident
    - Right medicine
    - Right dose
    - Right time
    - Right route
- Confirm identity using at least two identifiers (e.g., name and date of birth)
- Ensure privacy and dignity during administration

5.4 Documentation

- Complete Medication Administration Records (MAR) accurately and promptly
- Record refusals, missed doses, and any adverse reactions
- Maintain confidentiality of medicines records

5.5 Disposal

- Dispose of unwanted, out-of-date, or unused medicines according to local protocols
- Controlled drugs must be disposed of in line with legal requirements and witnessed
- Maintain disposal records

6. Controlled Drugs (CDs)

- Maintain a controlled drugs register for all CDs received, administered, or disposed
- Only authorised staff may access CDs
- Conduct regular audits of CDs
- Report discrepancies or theft immediately to management and authorities

7. Resident Involvement

- Respect residents' rights to be involved in decisions about their medicines
- Provide information and support about medicines as appropriate
- Record any allergies or adverse drug reactions

8. Training and Competency

- All staff involved in medicines management will receive training at induction and refresher courses annually
- Competency assessments are carried out regularly
- Records of training and competency must be maintained

9. Incident Reporting

- All medicines errors, near misses, and adverse events must be reported immediately
- Investigations will be conducted, and learning shared to improve practice
- Report serious incidents to the CQC as per regulations

10. Monitoring and Audit

- Regular audits of medicines storage, administration, and records will be conducted
- Action plans will be developed to address any areas of non-compliance

11. Related Policies

- Safeguarding Adults Policy
- Consent Policy
- Infection Prevention and Control Policy
- Staff Training and Development Policy

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